

POLICY & SOP

Warehouse & Distribution Logistics SOP

Version: 3.3 | Effective Date: 01-Apr-2026 | Owner: Head of Supply Chain | Applicable To: All Company & C&F Agent Warehouses

1. Purpose & Scope

This SOP standardises inbound, storage, and outbound processes across SCPL's company-owned warehouses and Carrying & Forwarding (C&F) Agent locations to ensure product quality, shelf-life integrity, and on-time delivery to distributors.

2. Inbound Receiving Process

- 1 Security verifies the inbound vehicle against the Advance Shipment Notice (ASN) raised by the plant/DC.
- 2 Warehouse team inspects for transit damage, checks batch numbers, and verifies quantity against the delivery challan.
- 3 Quality check: sample inspection for packaging integrity and, for food products, checks against the Certificate of Analysis (CoA).
- 4 Goods Receipt Note (GRN) is created in the WMS within 4 hours of unloading; discrepancies are flagged via a Damage/Shortage Report.
- 5 Stock is put away to the designated storage zone based on SKU velocity classification (fast/medium/slow moving).

3. Storage & FEFO Guidelines

All food and beverage products are managed on a strict **First-Expiry-First-Out (FEFO)** basis. Warehouse Management System (WMS) enforces FEFO-based picking; manual override requires Warehouse Manager approval and is logged for audit.

Product Category	Max Storage Temperature	Shelf-Life Alert Trigger
Tea & Coffee (packaged)	Ambient, <30°C, low humidity	75% of shelf life elapsed
Ready-to-Eat / Snacks	Ambient, <27°C	70% of shelf life elapsed
Salt & Spices	Ambient, dry storage	80% of shelf life elapsed

4. Outbound Dispatch Process

- 1 Distributor order is received via the DMS (Distributor Management System) and converted to a Sales Order.
- 2 WMS auto-allocates stock per FEFO logic and generates a picklist.
- 3 Picked stock is quality-checked and loaded per the route plan; e-way bill and invoice are generated prior to gate-out.
- 4 Proof of Delivery (POD) is captured electronically by the distributor/transporter and reconciled within 24 hours.

5. Damage & Returns Handling

- Transit-damaged goods are quarantined in a designated area and logged in the Damage Register within 24 hours of identification.
- Distributor return requests must be raised within 7 days of delivery for damage/quality issues, or 48 hours for short-shipment claims.
- Approved returns are credited to the distributor account within 10 working days of physical receipt and quality verification at the warehouse.

6. Safety Guidelines

All warehouse personnel must comply with SCPL's Warehouse Safety Manual, including mandatory use of PPE in loading bays, safe manual handling practices, and fire safety protocols for high-density storage zones.